CHAPTER 10

Programming with Objects

Object-oriented programming (OOP) as a paradigm first appeared in the 1960s. Two early pioneers were Ole-Johan Dahl and Kristen Nygaard, who created the Simula language. Simula introduced concepts such as classes, inheritance, and abstract methods (virtual procedures) and was a major influence on another very well-known OOP language: Smalltalk (Xerox PARC). Smalltalk went on to influence the OOP languages in use today, including PHP. Key features that were introduced in the Simula language are still predominant in OOP today; these were

- Objects and classes
- Inheritance and sub-typing
- Abstract methods (virtual procedures)

Modern PHP is by design an object-oriented language. From version 3 onwards the set of OOP features has continued to grow and be refined, and in this chapter, we will learn how best to deploy these features (collectively known as the "object model"). We've already looked at many of the fundamentals of OOP; this chapter assumes you have read and absorbed Chapter 6, "Object Fundamentals." To recap, this chapter assumes that you understand the following concepts:

- Object instantiation
- Properties and methods
- Accessing static and non-static members
- Object context vs. class context
- Classes, anonymous classes, and their members

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